

Politics News Digest - 2026-09-28

===== 2026-09-28 =====

--- India ---

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/>

1. Congress calls EC's SIR response 'damage control', says concerns remain unaddressed

The main opposition party says the Election Commission's reply on the Special Intensive Revision of voter rolls has not resolved its objections.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/congress-calls-ecs-sir-response-damage-control-says-concerns-remain-unaddressed/article71516277.ece>

2. Congress to discuss party's strategy on ECI; senior leaders demand Gyanesh Kumar's resignation

The dispute between Congress and the Election Commission is escalating, with senior leaders now calling for the Chief Election Commissioner to step down.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/congress-to-discuss-partys-strategy-on-eci-senior-leaders-demand-gyanesh-kumars-resignation/article71519503.ece>

3. M.A. Baby meets Kejriwal ahead of INDIA bloc meeting on Election Commission

Opposition parties are coordinating ahead of a joint INDIA bloc meeting focused on the Election Commission.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/ma-baby-meets-kejriwal-ahead-of-india-bloc-meeting-on-election-commission/article71516130.ece>

4. West Bengal Congress leader moves Supreme Court for time-bound, independent inquiry, stay on SIR implementation

The voter-roll revision controversy has reached the Supreme Court, with a petition asking it to halt the SIR in West Bengal pending an inquiry.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/west-bengal-congress-leader-moves-supreme-court-for-time-bound-independent-inquiry-stay-on-sir-implementation/article71519212.ece>

5. Supreme Court urges West Bengal Assembly Speaker to decide disqualification petitions within October 8

The court is pressing for a deadline on pending anti-defection cases, which could affect the composition of the state legislature.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/supreme-court-urges-west-bengal-assembly-speaker-to-decide-disqualification-petitions-within-october-8/article71518848.ece>

6. Supreme Court Collegium proposes second woman as apex court judge in 2026

The recommendation would add another woman judge to the Supreme Court bench this year, subject to government approval.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/supreme-court-collegium-proposes-second-woman-as-apex-court-judge-in-2026/article71520601.ece>

7. Supreme Court asks Centre to consider exempting Class 6 students from CBSE three-language policy this year

The court's suggestion bears on the contested three-language education policy and how quickly it is rolled out.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/supreme-court-asks-centre-to-consider-exempting-class-6-students-from-cbse-three-language-policy-this-year/article71520259.ece>

8. Amid concerns over Russia sanctions law, Foreign Secretary meets U.S. delegation

India is engaging Washington as a U.S. sanctions law targeting Russia raises concerns about possible effects on Indian trade.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/amid-concerns-over-russia-sanctions-law-foreign-secretary-meets-us-delegation/article71516990.ece>

9. Goyal to visit U.S. for G20 Trade Ministers' meeting; hold trade pact talks with Greer

The Commerce Minister's visit could advance India-U.S. trade agreement negotiations alongside the G20 meeting.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/goyal-to-visit-us-for-g20-trade-ministers-meeting-hold-trade-pact-talks-with-greer/article71520242.ece>

10. Don't allow MMDR Act to be implemented in Odisha, Naveen Patnaik calls for united fight

Odisha's opposition leader is rallying resistance to the mining law, which he opposes over its impact on the state.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/odisha/dont-allow-mmdr-act-to-be-implemented-in-odisha-naveen-patnaik-calls-for-united-fight/article71518870.ece>

--- International ---

Source: <https://www.bbc.com/news/world>

1. Embattled Serbian president resigns, paving way for early elections

Aleksandar Vucic's resignation after prolonged anti-corruption protests opens the way to early elections in Serbia.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/ckpq0g7z5pjjo>

2. Trump-Xi summit: What wasn't said might matter the most

Analysis of the Washington summit between the US and Chinese leaders suggests key issues went unaddressed publicly.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cxp84g2ly1mjo>

3. Venezuela releases dozens of political prisoners as election calls grow

Dissidents are being freed days after Venezuela's interim leader met the US president, amid growing calls for elections.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c620lrw2xr12o>

4. Seoul summons Ukraine envoy over North Korean prisoner-of-war row

South Korea objects to Ukraine publicly revealing the transfer of two captured North Korean soldiers, which Seoul says was meant to stay secret.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c8ly40xx0dr0o>

5. Inside Yemen's front-line city as Houthis battle for control

Rare BBC access to the front line shows the ongoing fight between pro-government forces and the Houthis.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cw98005ndz7no>

6. Plan for controversial Sydney data centre scrapped after push-back

The developer cites changes to the policy and regulatory environment, showing how government rules are shaping large data-centre projects.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c6n9wrqpj4yqo>

7. Why some Indian civil servants become heroes for doing their jobs

The piece looks at how officials who simply follow the rules win public praise in a bureaucracy known for delays.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cw980vje6l3eo>

Top themes today: Election Commission and voter-roll (SIR) dispute in India, Supreme Court interventions, India-US trade and sanctions diplomacy, political transitions in Serbia and Venezuela